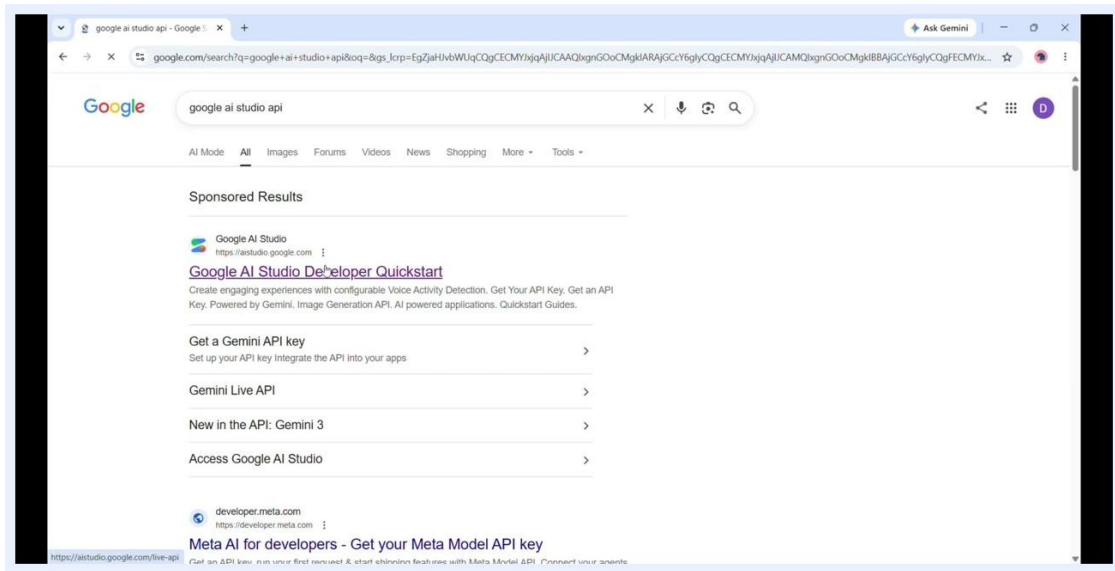


- A Create API key button in the upper right



Google AI Studio API Keys page

Step 4: Copy the Gemini API key

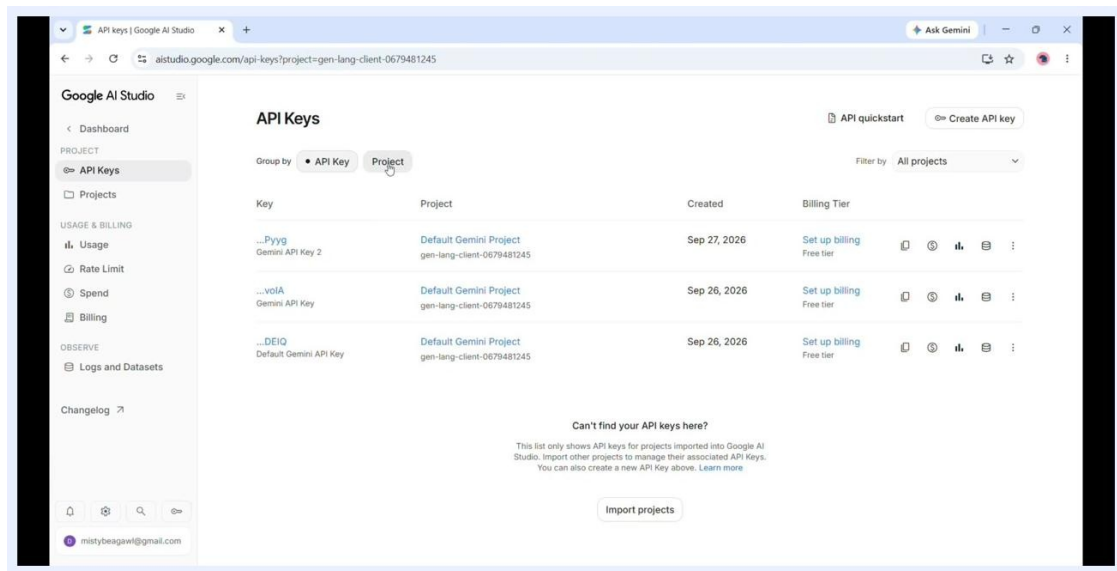
Click Create API key to generate a new one, or select an existing Gemini API key from the list. Copy the key value — you'll need it in the next step.

Step 5: Add the API key to your .env file

Return to Visual Studio Code and paste the copied key into the `GEMINI_API_KEY` field in your `.env` (or `.env.example`) file:

```
GEMINI_API_KEY=AQ.AB8Rn6JqfUqR2yLfn6fM4ZUzSWtNofpkOn1GZSHsNHbYrTw
```

Confirm the other environment variables are set as needed before continuing.



.env file with Gemini API key filled in

Step 6: Activate the Python virtual environment

Open the integrated terminal in VS Code and activate the virtual environment:

- On Windows: `.\venv\Scripts\Activate.ps1`

Your terminal prompt should now show the environment is active, indicated by `(venv)`.

Step 7: Start the application

Navigate to the project directory if needed (`cd PocketSmartAI`), then start the app:

```
python run.py
```

You should see confirmation in the terminal output:

```
INFO: Uvicorn running on http://127.0.0.1:8000
INFO: Application startup complete
```